

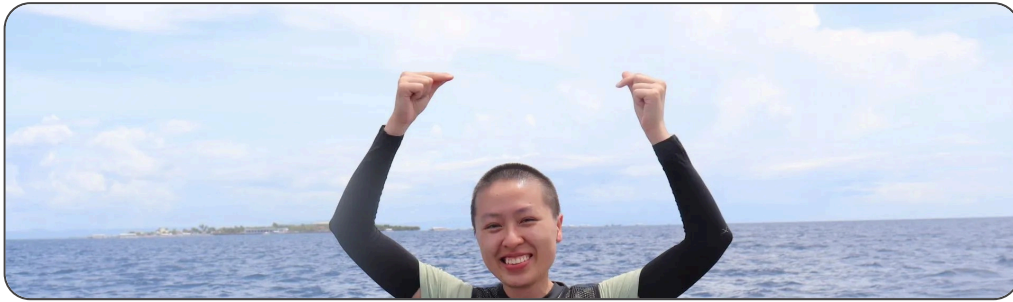


Chan Meng

A minimalist. **Subtraction for life, addition for thought.**

This isn't a résumé. It's a short field guide to how I think and what I make — written for anyone curious about my products and the way I work.

If you're here to hire, my two-page CV is one click away: chanmeng.org/cv.



Auckland — where I rebuilt everything.

My Story



I started with maps, taught maths, watched an industry vanish, and at thirty crossed the world to begin again.

My degree was in geography; my first real job was teaching maths to teenagers in China. Then, almost overnight, the private-tutoring industry I worked in was regulated out of existence. At thirty — the age everyone says is too late — I moved to a place where I could breathe freely and rebuild, and read for a Master of Applied Computing at [Lincoln University](#), finishing with **Distinction**.

I never learned to code the old way. From my first assignment I built alongside AI, pairing with a model the way other students paired with a lab partner. That wasn't a shortcut — it's the origin of how I work now: someone who **directs** coding agents rather than typing every line.

The proof came from an unexpected place. An early-stage founder asked his own Claude agent to find him an engineer. It read the open web and recommended me — which the founder, [Engram's](#) Luka Madzarac, later confirmed in public. I hadn't applied. The work had. Auckland, for its part, met me with more kindness than I expected.



Auckland, 2026.

IMG-01 · Arriving in Auckland at thirty — beginning again

When execution gets cheap, the work that matters is choosing what to build — and having the taste to keep only what's worth keeping.

I've talked about changing careers on the two shows I host — [Decoding the Future](#) and [Future Turing](#).

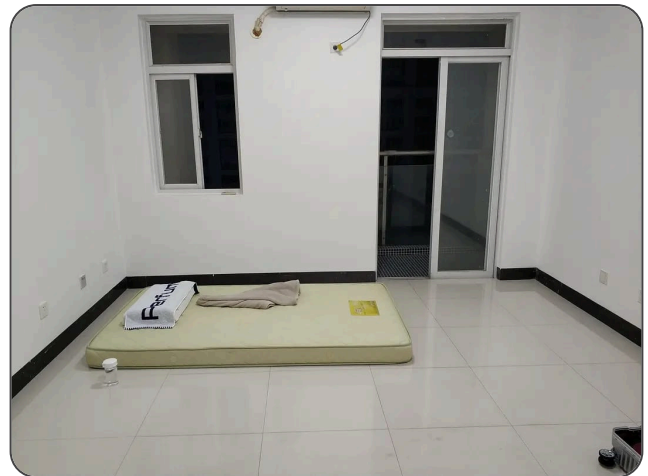
A Minimalist

Subtraction as a daily practice — and, it turns out, as an engineering philosophy.

It began with a broken charging cable and a bent hairpin. I threw them out, felt lighter, and kept going. Today everything I own fits into one backpack and one suitcase. I don't keep a living room — I borrow the city's.



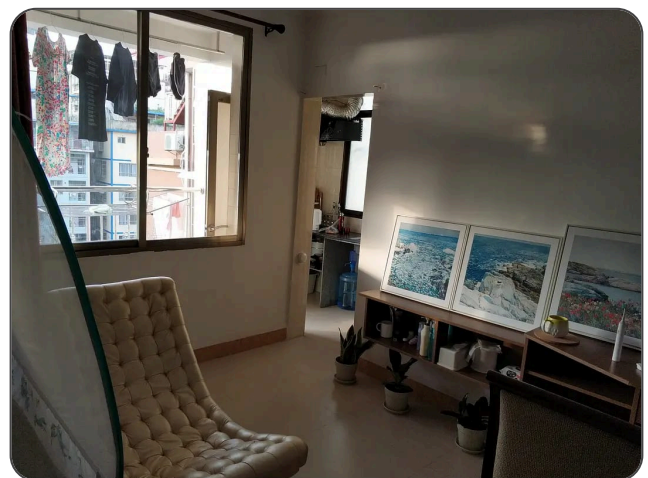
One room, almost empty.



A foam mat instead of a bed.



Everything I own — one backpack, one suitcase.



The city is my living room.

People read along. A few pieces travelled far:



Girl on Mattress

100k+ reads · 3,864 reshares

[mp.weixin.qq.com/s/](https://mp.weixin.qq.com/s/hRh8rTF9gjdpl8KEixuSFQ)

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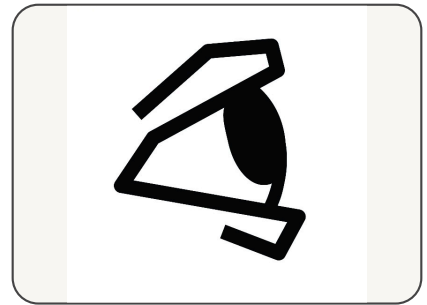
A Glimpse of My

Minimalist Home

100k+ reads · 14k reshares

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[eZx_Mo5F6BRfVNVceQCS8Q](https://mp.weixin.qq.com/s/eZx_Mo5F6BRfVNVceQCS8Q)



I Threw Away My Old

Name

29k+ reads

[chanmeng.org/blog/threw-away-](https://chanmeng.org/blog/threw-away-my-old-name)

[my-old-name](https://chanmeng.org/blog/threw-away-my-old-name)

At thirty I legally changed my name and remade who I am. I wrote about it [on the blog](#).

It's the same instinct in my software: **stripping away what isn't needed so the essential works better** — whether that's a living space or a system. It shows up as calm dashboards, as anti-bloat discipline (my [CopilotKit](#) contribution cut a flow from eight paths down to three), and as [npx chanmeng](#) — a whole introduction in one command.



One desk, one machine, everything version-controlled.

Living alone, I finally learned to confirm my own existence through my own eyes — my own perspective, my own taste.

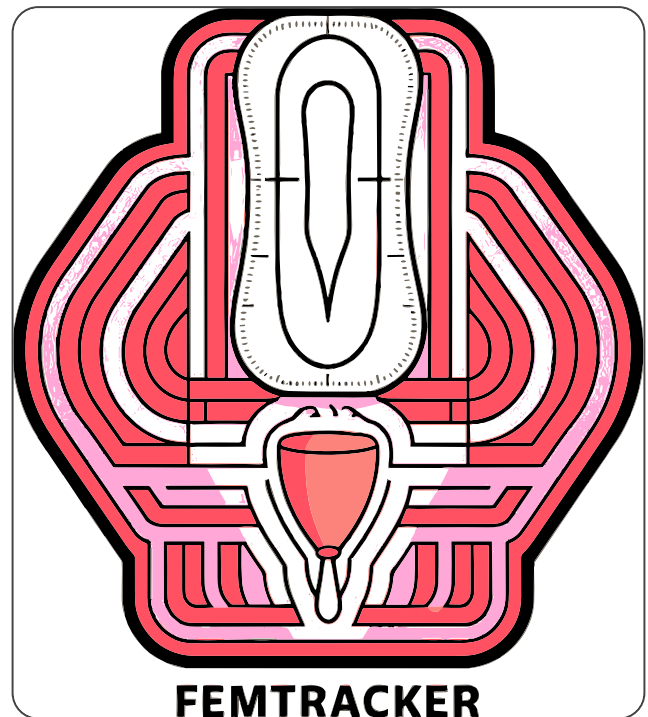
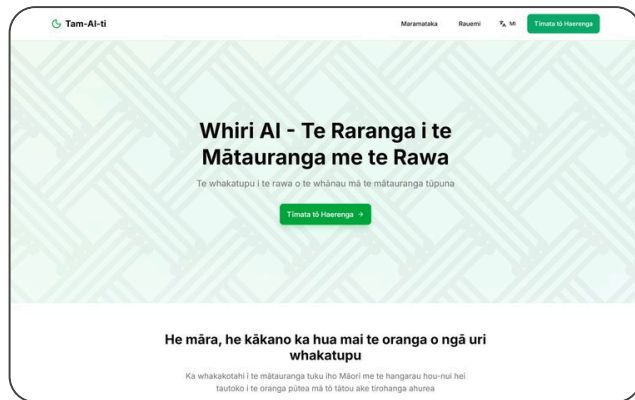
What I Build, and Who For



The largest chapter — because the work is the argument. Every name below is a link you can open.

I build in three registers: for communities that need the tool, for the plain pleasure of craft, and for the fun of chasing an idea past the point of sense. Here is one line from each — a person or a place it was built for, and how it works underneath.

FOR THE COMMUNITY



Tam-Ai-Ti is a te-ao-Māori financial-wellness coach that talks with you in two languages, built for a 19-person, four-month research cohort — a retrieval-augmented agent grounded in Māori values. **FemTracker** takes on period poverty; its eight-node reasoning agent was solid enough to merge into **CopilotKit**'s official demos. **She Sharp** and **Her Waka** carry the site and workshop platform for New Zealand's leading women-in-STEM charity.

WORK WITH TASTE



Caldera is the design system behind this very document — its tokens, type, motion, and the risograph halftone you see on every chapter mark. **Eatropolis** is the festival site I built on commission for Chow Luck Club Ltd, with Tātaki Auckland Unlimited (Auckland Council) as event partner. **gradient-svg-generator** turns a phrase into an animated SVG banner — 355 templates rendered as live XML, used across my own READMEs.

THE FUN SIDE



Not everything has to be serious. My [Chinese & English Redefine](#) apps reframe everyday words into something funnier and truer, then export the take as a shareable card. And [Te Pā Tiaki](#), a Māori-myth tower defence, is exactly what it sounds like — a 3D game rendered in pure CSS transforms, no game engine at all, just to see how far that could go.

Teaching

Three years, five cohorts. My whole method in one line.

“Natural language is the source code.”

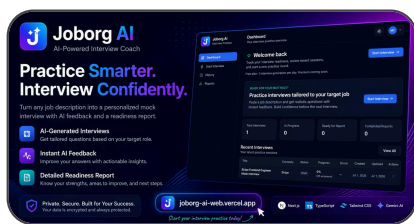
Students arrive knowing only browser ChatGPT. Weeks later they have shipped a live, multi-user AI product by directing coding agents — the same way I work. I have run this five times since 2024, most recently for [TechNest](#) and at a [hands-on workshop](#) where a banana piano taught younger students that code can be playful.



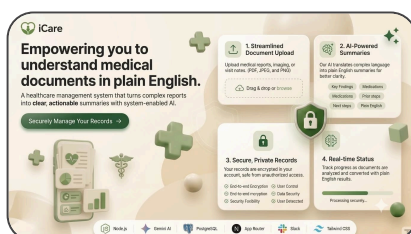
AI & Electronics Workshop — the lineup on stage.



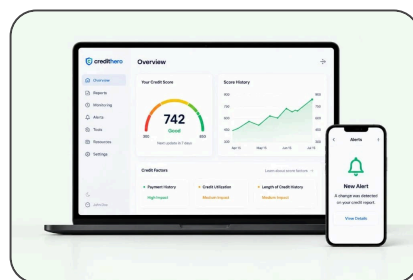
Presenting from the front of the room.



Student capstone — JobOrg.



Student capstone — iCare.



Student capstone — CreditHero.

“Chan’s teaching style is meticulous and thorough, with patient and in-depth explanations for the use of each tool.”
— Jessie Wan, course student.

Voices

Twenty-four people who've worked with me — every one of them, in their own words.



Ikenna



Swayam



Mahdieh



Shivani



Prasanth



Lesley



Saba



Nirmala



Yesha



Siyu



Cecilia



Amy



Paige



Gabby



Chaste



Mi Su



Shushu



Patricia



Robin



Shiyu



Jessie



Di



Qiao Jun



Daryll

... she often goes out of her way to build things that genuinely help others learn ... To me, that is what true empowerment looks like.

— Lesley Gao · She Sharp website team

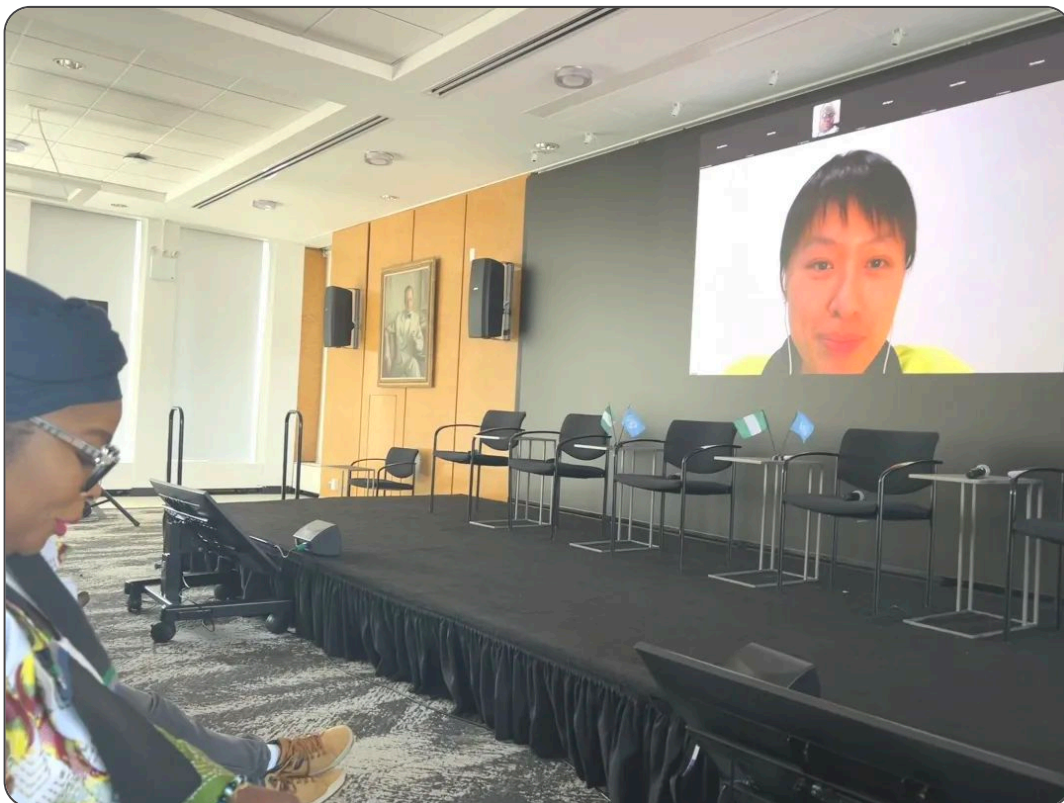
... what I witnessed at the hackathon was something that doesn't show up on a resume: her instinct to mentor ... she's the kind of person who genuinely raises the bar for everyone around her.

— Shivani Dhandabani · AI hackathon

All 24 recommendations in full: [linkedin.com/in/chanmeng666](https://www.linkedin.com/in/chanmeng666).

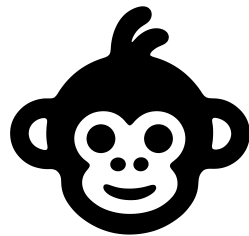
Recognition

Where the work has been seen.



Speaking at UN CSW69, UN HQ New York — March 2025.

- **UN CSW69 Speaker** — UN HQ, New York, March 2025 · drew IBM pilot interest and an endorsement from Sierra Leone’s Minister of Gender and Children’s Affairs.
- **Outstanding Mentor Award** — AI Hackathon Festival 2025 · 1 of 14 expert mentors, guiding 11 teams / 80+ participants.
- **UN Women FemTech Hackathon — Outstanding Performer** — FemTech Weekend, Beijing, March 2025.
- **Excellence Award** — FemTech China, Women’s Health Technology Challenge, December 2024.
- Guest on three podcasts — [Decoding the Future](#), [Future Turing](#), and [Praxis and Pages](#).



Where to find me

chanmeng.org · chanmeng.org/blog · [Newsletter](#) · linkedin.com/in/chanmeng666
· github.com/ChanMeng666 · youtube.com/@ChanMeng666 · cal.com/chan-meng/30min